LINKEDIN + INTERVIEW ANSWER WORKBOOK

Headline & About Templates • Profile Positioning • Interview Answer Frameworks • STAR Story Bank • Practice Worksheets

A practical, research-informed workbook for freshers, experienced professionals, career switchers and returning candidates.

How this book is designed

Use it as a working document. Draft first, then refine. The goal is not to sound impressive; it is to make your target role, relevant evidence and value easy to understand.

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Research note

This workbook was developed using current LinkedIn Help/Talent Solutions guidance and established university/career-service interview guidance, including STAR-based behavioral preparation. LinkedIn's own documentation confirms that the headline appears in search results and that the About section is a place to express mission, motivation and skills. See the research notes at the end.

01 | HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

Build the profile first. Build the answers second. Connect both to the same target role.

- **Step 1 — Choose one target role.** Avoid writing a generic profile for five unrelated careers.
- **Step 2 — Extract the role language.** Collect recurring job titles, skills, tools, responsibilities and outcomes from 5–10 relevant job descriptions.
- **Step 3 — Build your headline.** Make your target identity and relevant keywords obvious without stuffing.
- **Step 4 — Build your About section.** Explain what you do, the problems you solve, evidence of impact and what you are looking for.
- **Step 5 — Build your story bank.** Prepare 6–8 flexible stories rather than memorising 30 scripts.
- **Step 6 — Practice aloud.** Strong written answers can sound unnatural if they are memorised word-for-word.
- **Step 7 — Review after each interview.** Record the question, your answer, missing evidence and one improvement for next time.

The consistency rule

Your LinkedIn headline, About, resume and interview answers should tell the same professional story. If your resume says “data analyst” but your LinkedIn headline says “marketing enthusiast” and your interview answer says you want to move into product management, the recruiter has to resolve the contradiction. Make the intended direction clear.

Your target role for this workbook:

_____

_____

02

LinkedIn Positioning System

Turn a profile from a digital résumé into a clear professional proposition.

What the headline and About section are supposed to do

LinkedIn describes the headline as the text below your name, displayed in search results and usable to promote an area of expertise. The About section is intended for your mission, motivation and skills. LinkedIn also says profile information such as headline, About, experience and education can inform job recommendations. These are reasons to treat the top of the profile as a positioning system—not a collection of disconnected sentences.

A useful positioning equation

POSITIONING
[Target role] + [core capability] + [domain/context] + [credible proof or value] + [direction, if useful]

Example: Data Analyst | SQL & Power BI | Turning messy operational data into decision-ready insights

Four questions to answer before you write

What role do I want next? _____	**What problems can I solve?** _____
Which 3–5 skills prove relevance? _____	**What evidence can I point to?** _____

03 | HEADLINE TEMPLATES & BUILDER

The headline is a compact positioning statement—not a list of adjectives.

A strong headline usually makes at least three things clear: **who you are professionally**, **what you can do**, and **what direction or value you bring**. LinkedIn confirms the headline is visible in search results and can be separate from your current job title.

01 — Role + Skills + Domain
[Target Role] | [Skill 1] + [Skill 2] | [Domain / Business Area]

Example: Business Analyst | SQL + Power BI | Process Improvement & Business Insights

02 — Role + Outcome
[Target Role] | Helping [team/business] [outcome] through [capability]

Example: Marketing Analyst | Helping teams turn customer data into clearer campaign decisions

03 — Fresher
Aspiring [Target Role] | [2–3 relevant skills] | [Project / domain] | Open to [role]

Example: Aspiring Data Analyst | Excel, SQL & Power BI | Projects in Sales & Operations Analytics | Open to Analyst Roles

04 — Experienced
[Current/Target Role] | [Specialism] | [Scope/impact] | [Industry]

Example: Senior Operations Manager | Process Excellence | Multi-site Operations & Cost Control | Logistics

05 — Career Switch
[Current identity] → [Target role] | [Transferable skills] | [Proof]

Example: Operations Professional → Business Analyst | Process Mapping, Excel & Stakeholder Management | 3 Years in Service Operations

06 — Specialist
[Specialist] | [Niche expertise] | [Tools / methods] | [Outcome]

Example: SEO Specialist | Technical SEO + Content Strategy | Growing Organic Visibility Through Search-Led Content

07 — Project/Portfolio-led
[Target Role] | Building [type of work] | [tools] | [portfolio/project proof]

Example: Frontend Developer | React + TypeScript | Building Accessible, Responsive Web Experiences | Portfolio: 5 Projects

08 — Finance
[Role] | [Finance capability] | [Tools] | [business value]

Example: FP&A Analyst | Financial Modeling + Variance Analysis | Excel & Power BI | Turning Numbers into Planning Insights

09 — HR
[HR role] | [specialism] | [people/business outcome]

Example: HR Generalist | Recruitment + Employee Relations | Supporting Managers and Improving Employee Experience

10 — Sales
[Role] | [segment] | [sales motion] | [evidence]

Example: B2B Sales Executive | SaaS | Prospecting + Consultative Selling | Pipeline & Account Growth

11 — Product
[Product role] | [problem space] | [methods/tools] | [impact]

Example: Product Analyst | Experimentation + Product Metrics | SQL, Amplitude & Excel | Customer-Focused Decision Making

12 — “Open to Work” without sounding generic
[Target role] | [skills] | [location/work mode] | Open to opportunities

Example: Customer Success Associate | Onboarding, CRM & Stakeholder Management | Bengaluru / Hybrid | Open to Opportunities

Headline Builder — Draft 3 versions

Write three deliberately different versions. Version A is keyword-forward; B is value-forward; C is human but still specific. Pick the version that best matches your target role and evidence.

Target role / title _____	**Core skill 1** _____
Core skill 2 _____	**Core skill 3** _____
Domain / industry _____	**Tool / technology** _____
Outcome I can support _____	**Proof point / project** _____
Location / work mode (optional) _____	**Career direction (optional)** _____

Headline Examples by Candidate Situation

Use these as patterns, not as copy-paste identities. Replace generic claims with your actual skills and evidence.

Fresher with projects	Business Analytics Graduate | Excel, SQL & Power BI | Sales & Operations Projects | Seeking Entry-Level Analyst Roles
Fresher with internship	MBA Graduate | Marketing Analytics & Research | Excel, PowerPoint & GA4 | Internship Experience in B2C Growth
No experience yet	Computer Science Graduate | Python, SQL & Java | Backend & Data Projects | Open to Software / Data Roles
Experienced specialist	Procurement Specialist | Vendor Management + Cost Analysis | ERP & Contract Operations | Manufacturing
Experienced manager	Operations Manager | Process Improvement + Team Leadership | SLA, Cost & Service Delivery | 10+ Years
Career switch	Teacher → Learning & Development Professional | Facilitation, Curriculum Design & Stakeholder Management | Corporate Training
Career returner	Finance Professional Returning to Work | Accounting, Reporting & Excel | Ready for FP&A / Finance Operations
Contract/freelance	Graphic Designer | Brand Identity + Presentation Design | Adobe Creative Suite | B2B & Startup Projects

Avoid these headline traps

“Looking for opportunities” by itself • “Hardworking and passionate professional” • a long list of unrelated skills • inflated titles you cannot substantiate • keyword stuffing • vague claims such as “results-driven” with no evidence. Specificity beats decoration.

04 | ABOUT SECTION TEMPLATES & BUILDER

Write the About section as a short professional narrative: identity → capability → proof → direction.

LinkedIn describes About as a place to express your mission, motivation and skills. LinkedIn's own Talent Solutions guidance also recommends identifying the audience and goal, explaining what you do, why you do it, what is valuable to the reader and what sets you apart.

The 5-block About framework
1) Opening identity: I'm a [role/background] focused on [area]. 2) What I do: I work on [problems/responsibilities]. 3) Evidence: In [project/role], I [action] and [result]. 4) Strengths: My strongest areas are [3–4 relevant skills]. 5) Direction: I'm interested in [target roles/problems] and open to [type of opportunity].

Formatting principles

- Lead with a sentence that makes the reader want to continue.
- Use short paragraphs and bullets where they improve scanning.
- Prefer evidence over adjectives: show the project, scope, metric, customer, process or outcome.
- Write for the person who may hire or refer you—not for an abstract "audience."
- Keep the profile truthful. AI can help draft and edit, but it should not invent achievements, tools, titles or metrics.

01 — Fresher / Graduate

Copy-and-customize template
I'm a [degree/discipline] graduate interested in [target role/function], with hands-on experience through [projects/internships/coursework]. I enjoy working on problems that involve [problem type], and I've built practical skills in [skill 1], [skill 2] and [skill 3]. Recent work includes: • [Project] — [what you did + result] • [Project] — [what you did + result] I'm especially interested in [industry/domain] and roles where I can contribute through [capability] while continuing to develop [skill]. Open to: [target roles] | [location/work mode]

02 — Experienced Professional

Copy-and-customize template
I'm a [role] with [X] years of experience in [function/industry], focused on [specialism/problem area]. Across [companies/teams], I've worked on [2–3 major responsibilities] and helped deliver [business outcomes]. Selected highlights: • [Achievement + metric] • [Achievement + scope] • [Achievement + business/customer impact] Core strengths: [skill], [skill], [skill], [skill]. I'm currently interested in [target role / problem space] where I can bring my experience in [capability] to [business outcome].

03 — Career Switcher

Copy-and-customize template
I'm a [current/previous role] transitioning into [target role]. My previous experience has given me strong foundations in [transferable skill 1], [skill 2] and [skill 3]. The move is deliberate: I'm most energized by [problem/work] and have been building evidence through [course/project/freelance/internship]. A recent example: [project] where I [action] and [result]. I'm now looking for [target roles] where I can combine my experience in [old domain] with my developing expertise in [new domain].

04 — Career Returner

Copy-and-customize template
I'm a [profession] with prior experience in [function], returning to the workforce after [career break / caregiving / personal reason]. Before the break, I worked on [responsibilities] and delivered [evidence]. I have since refreshed my skills in [tools/skills] through [course/project/practice]. My strengths include [3 skills], and I'm particularly interested in [target role/function]. I'm open to opportunities that value strong fundamentals, a learning mindset and the ability to contribute reliably from day one.

05 — Project/Portfolio-led Candidate

Copy-and-customize template
I'm a [role] focused on [specialism], with a portfolio built around [type of work]. My recent work includes: • [Project] — [problem → solution → result] • [Project] — [problem → solution → result] • [Project] — [problem → solution → result] Tools: [tools]. Strengths: [skills]. I'm looking for [target role] opportunities where I can apply [capability] to real business/customer problems.

06 — Specialist / Consultant

Copy-and-customize template
I help [type of client/team] solve [specific problem] through [specialism]. My work spans [2–3 capabilities], with a focus on [outcome]. Examples include [brief evidence]. People typically work with me when they need [problem] and value [strength]. I'm interested in [engagement/role type] across [industry/domain], especially where the challenge involves [specific problem].

About Section: Evidence Bank

Before drafting your final About section, collect raw material. You do not need to use everything.

One-line professional identity _____	**Target role** _____
Top 5 skills _____	**Top 3 tools / technologies** _____
Best project _____	**Best measurable result** _____
Scope: people / customers / revenue / volume _____	**Problem I solve well** _____
Industry / domain knowledge _____	**What I want next** _____
Location / work mode _____	**Proof links / portfolio** _____

05 | KEYWORDS, CONSISTENCY & PROFILE AUDIT

Use keywords to improve clarity and relevance—not to manipulate the reader.

LinkedIn says skills can be shown explicitly in the Skills section and also inferred from text across profile sections; its Skills Match feature can compare profile information with job-post skills. LinkedIn recommends keeping profile information current and descriptive.

Build a three-layer keyword map

Layer 1 — Job titles (e.g., Business Analyst, FP&A Analyst) _____	**Layer 2 — Core skills (e.g., SQL, forecasting, recruitment)** _____
Layer 3 — Context/outcomes (e.g., churn, cost reduction, hiring) _____	

Where to align them

- Headline: include the most important target identity and a few highly relevant capabilities.
- About: use natural language to explain those capabilities in context.
- Experience: connect skills to responsibilities, projects and outcomes.
- Skills: list the skills you genuinely possess; prioritise relevance over quantity.
- Resume: keep terminology consistent where it is accurate to do so.

Important

A keyword is useful only if it is true. Do not claim software, certifications, industries, titles or levels of expertise you do not have. Your interview is where unsupported claims become visible.

LinkedIn Profile Audit — 20-minute checklist

■ Target role is obvious within a few seconds.
■ Headline contains specific professional language, not only personality adjectives.
■ About opening sentence clearly identifies professional direction.
■ About includes evidence, projects, scope or outcomes.
■ Experience descriptions support the same career story.
■ Skills section reflects the target role and actual capabilities.
■ Job titles are accurate and understandable to an external recruiter.
■ Dates and career transitions are internally consistent.
■ Location/work mode is current.
■ Profile photo and background image look professional and appropriate for the target market.
■ Featured/project links work and support credibility where relevant.
■ Resume and LinkedIn tell the same story.
■ Nothing in the profile overclaims expertise.
■ Spelling, grammar and formatting have been checked.

One sentence I want a recruiter to remember:

_____

_____

06

Interview Answer Operating System

Prepare flexible answers, not memorised speeches.

What interviewers are trying to learn

- **Can you do the work?** Evidence of skills, knowledge and execution.
- **How do you think?** Structure, judgement, prioritisation and problem-solving.
- **How do you work with people?** Communication, collaboration, conflict handling and stakeholder management.
- **Why this role?** Motivation that makes sense for the role and company.
- **Can you communicate clearly?** Concise, relevant answers with enough evidence.

The answer formula

For most questions
Answer directly → give the most relevant evidence → explain the result/learning → connect back to the role when useful.

Example: I've worked on X. A relevant example is Y. I did Z, which led to A. That experience is directly relevant here because…

For behavioral questions, STAR remains a strong preparation framework. Harvard and Indeed both recommend Situation–Task–Action–Result for structuring behavioral/situational answers; both also emphasise concrete examples and results.

07 | CORE INTERVIEW ANSWER TEMPLATES

Tell me about yourself

Framework

Present → Past → Proof → Future. Start with your current identity, give 1–2 relevant experiences, mention one or two proof points, then explain why this role is the logical next step.

Draft
I'm currently a [role/student] focused on [area]. Over the last [period], I've built experience in [skills]. One project I'm particularly proud of is [example], where I [action] and [result]. I'm now looking to apply that experience in [target role], especially in a team working on [problem/domain].

Why do you want this role?

Framework

Role fit → evidence → motivation. Avoid a generic "I want growth" answer.

Draft
This role fits me because it combines [responsibility] with [skill]. In my previous work/project, I've already done [relevant evidence]. I'm particularly interested in [specific part of role] because [reason].

Why do you want to work here?

Framework

Company-specific reason → role-specific contribution → informed motivation.

Draft
I'm interested in [company] because of [specific product/market/mission/work]. The role's focus on [responsibility] matches my experience in [skill]. I'd be excited to contribute by [contribution].

Why should we hire you?

Framework

Relevant capability + proof + working style. Do not compare yourself to unknown candidates.

Draft
I bring three things that are relevant to this role: [skill], [skill] and [skill]. I've demonstrated them through [evidence]. I also work in a way that [strength], which would help me contribute to [role outcome].

What are your strengths?

Framework

Choose 2–3 strengths that matter for the role, then prove each with a brief example.

Draft
One strength is [strength], which I've demonstrated when [example]. Another is [strength], particularly in [context]. I'd highlight these because the role requires [requirement].

What is a weakness?

Framework

Choose a genuine but manageable development area. Explain the impact, what you changed and what is improving.

Draft
Earlier, I tended to [specific weakness]. I noticed it affected [impact]. I started [action] to address it, and I now [evidence of improvement]. It is still something I consciously manage by [habit].

Core Questions — Difficult Versions

Why are you leaving your current job?

Stay factual and forward-looking. Do not attack a former employer. Explain what you want next and why the role fits.

Your answer — key points	Evidence / example	One sentence
_____	_____	_____

Why is there a gap in your employment?

Brief context → what you did during the period → readiness now. Avoid excessive personal detail.

Your answer — key points	Evidence / example	One sentence
_____	_____	_____

Why are you changing careers?

Explain the deliberate connection between past skills and the target role, then give proof that you have tested the new direction.

Your answer — key points	Evidence / example	One sentence
_____	_____	_____

You don’t have the required experience. Why should we consider you?

Acknowledge the gap without apologising. Then show adjacent experience, projects, transferable skills and learning speed.

Your answer — key points	Evidence / example	One sentence
_____	_____	_____

What salary are you expecting?

Research the market and role, consider your current/previous compensation where relevant, and state a reasoned range if asked. Avoid inventing competing offers.

Your answer — key points	Evidence / example	One sentence
_____	_____	_____

What questions do you have for us?

Ask about success in the role, priorities, team interfaces, current challenges, onboarding and how performance is evaluated.

Your answer — key points	Evidence / example	One sentence
_____	_____	_____

08 | STAR STORY BANK & BEHAVIORAL ANSWERS

Do not prepare one story per question. Prepare a small set of versatile stories that can answer many behavioral prompts.

A useful story bank covers themes such as leadership, teamwork, conflict, problem-solving, failure, learning, prioritisation, ambiguity and measurable impact. Career-service guidance recommends mining your experience for stories and practicing them aloud.

STAR, used well

S — Situation	2–3 sentences of context. What was happening? Keep this short.
T — Task	What specifically were you responsible for achieving or solving?
A — Action	Spend most of the answer here. What did **you** decide, do, communicate or change?
R — Result	What changed? Use numbers where truthful. Include learning when useful.

STAR Story Bank — Stories 1–4

Story 1

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Story 2

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Story 3

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Story 4

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

STAR Story Bank — Stories 5–8

Story 5

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Story 6

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Story 7

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Story 8

Theme / competency _____	**Question(s) this story can answer** _____
Situation _____	**Task / responsibility** _____
Actions I personally took _____	**Result / metric / outcome** _____
What I learned _____	**60–90 second spoken version** _____

Behavioral Question Map

Leadership	Tell me about a time you led without formal authority.	Story # _____
Conflict	Tell me about a disagreement with a colleague or stakeholder.	Story # _____
Failure	Tell me about a time something went wrong. What did you do?	Story # _____
Prioritisation	Tell me about a time you had multiple urgent priorities.	Story # _____
Ambiguity	Tell me about a time you had incomplete information.	Story # _____
Customer	Tell me about a difficult customer or user.	Story # _____
Teamwork	Tell me about a time you helped a teammate succeed.	Story # _____
Learning	Tell me about a skill you had to learn quickly.	Story # _____
Initiative	Tell me about a time you improved a process without being asked.	Story # _____
Decision	Tell me about a difficult decision you made.	Story # _____
Feedback	Tell me about difficult feedback you received.	Story # _____
Ethics	Tell me about a time you had to do the right thing under pressure.	Story # _____

09 | ROLE-SPECIFIC & DIFFICULT QUESTIONS

Different roles require different evidence. Your answer structure can stay consistent while the proof changes.

Technical / IT / Data

Answer emphasis

Explain your approach before jumping to the answer. State assumptions, trade-offs, testing/validation and what you would do next if information is missing.

Marketing / Sales

Answer emphasis

Connect activity to customer, pipeline, revenue, retention, reach, conversion or learning. Avoid listing tasks without outcomes.

Finance / Operations

Answer emphasis

Emphasise accuracy, controls, process, prioritisation, cost, forecasting, risk and stakeholder communication.

HR / People

Answer emphasis

Use concrete examples involving hiring, employee experience, policy, conflict, confidentiality and stakeholder management.

Freshers / Campus

Answer emphasis

Use projects, internships, coursework, competitions, volunteering and part-time work as evidence. Explain what you personally did.

Managers / Senior professionals

Answer emphasis

Show scope, decisions, trade-offs, stakeholder alignment, coaching, risk management and business outcomes.

Technical / case question worksheet

Question / case _____	**Clarifying questions** _____
Assumptions _____	**Framework / structure** _____
Analysis / reasoning _____	**Recommendation** _____
Risks / trade-offs _____	**What I would validate next** _____

Handling Questions You Cannot Answer Immediately

A pause is better than a confident invention. Harvard career guidance notes that candidates can ask for clarification when a question is unclear, and that practicing responses improves interview performance.

Clarify
“I want to make sure I understand the question. Are you asking about [A] or [B]?”

Think aloud
“I haven’t handled that exact situation, but I’d approach it in three steps…”

Admit a gap professionally
“I haven’t used [tool] in a production environment yet. I have used [adjacent tool/skill], and I’ve started building [relevant project]. My approach would be…”

Recover after a weak answer
“Let me sharpen that answer. The main point I would want you to take away is…”

Your recovery phrases:

Recruiter Screen Worksheet

A recruiter screen often tests basic fit, motivation, communication, availability and compensation alignment before deeper interviews. Prepare concise answers.

30-second introduction _____	**Target role** _____
Current/last role _____	**Reason for move** _____
Top 3 relevant skills _____	**Most relevant achievement** _____
Location / relocation _____	**Notice period / availability** _____
Compensation expectations _____	**Work authorisation / practical constraints** _____
Why this company? _____	**Questions for recruiter** _____

10 | AI-ASSISTED PRACTICE SYSTEM

AI can accelerate preparation, but you remain responsible for accuracy and authenticity.

Harvard career guidance specifically recommends using generative AI to research, generate potential interview questions, brainstorm answers and evaluate STAR responses—but also warns that AI can produce factual errors and should be checked against trusted sources.

01 — Role-specific questions

```
Act as an interviewer for [ROLE] at a [COMPANY TYPE]. Based on this job description: [PASTE JD].
Generate 12 likely questions across recruiter, behavioral, role-specific and situational categories.
Do not provide answers yet.
```

02 — STAR critique

```
Here is my answer: [ANSWER]. Evaluate it using Situation, Task, Action and Result. Identify where I am
vague, where I over-explain, whether my own actions are clear, and whether the result is credible.
Then suggest a tighter version without inventing facts.
```

03 — Tell-me-about-yourself

```
Using my resume [PASTE] and this job description [PASTE], build a 60–90 second answer to “Tell me about
yourself.” Keep every factual claim traceable to my materials.
```

04 — Why this role

```
Compare my experience [PASTE] with this role [PASTE]. Identify 3 genuine connections I can use in a
“Why this role?” answer. Do not invent company facts.
```

05 — Mock interviewer

```
Interview me one question at a time for [ROLE]. Wait for my answer, then score clarity, relevance,
evidence and concision from 1–5 and ask the next question.
```

06 — Follow-up questions

```
Read my STAR answer and generate the 5 most difficult follow-up questions an interviewer could ask to
test whether I really owned the work.
```

07 — Red-team my answer

```
Act as a skeptical interviewer. Identify claims in my answer that sound unsupported, generic or
exaggerated. Ask what evidence would make each claim credible.
```

08 — Company research

```
Using only verified company sources I provide or current trusted sources, identify 5 facts relevant to
answering “Why this company?” and cite the source for each.
```

09 — Weakness answer

```
Help me improve this weakness answer: [ANSWER]. Preserve the truth. Make the development plan concrete and avoid turning the weakness into a disguised strength.
```

10 — Final rehearsal

```
Create a 20-minute mock interview for [ROLE] using my resume and job description. Include a scoring rubric and a final list of the three answers I should improve most.
```

Mock Interview Scorecard

Criterion	1	2	3	4	5	Notes
Direct answer	■	■	■	■	■	
Relevance	■	■	■	■	■	
Evidence	■	■	■	■	■	
Specificity	■	■	■	■	■	
Structure	■	■	■	■	■	
Conciseness	■	■	■	■	■	
Confidence / tone	■	■	■	■	■	
Role alignment	■	■	■	■	■	

Strongest answer _____	**Weakest answer** _____
Question I avoided _____	**Evidence I need to strengthen** _____
One delivery habit to change _____	**One answer to rehearse again** _____

7-Day Interview Preparation Plan

Day 1	**Role analysis** Read the job description. Extract 10 recurring skills/responsibilities. Write your 60–90 second introduction.
Day 2	**Story bank** Draft 6–8 STAR stories covering leadership, conflict, problem-solving, failure, teamwork and achievement.
Day 3	**Company research** Research product/service, customers, role priorities, recent developments and competitors using reliable sources.
Day 4	**Core answers** Draft Why this role, Why this company, strengths, weakness, achievement, failure and career-transition answers.
Day 5	**Role-specific practice** Practice technical/case questions. Explain your reasoning aloud and note assumptions /trade-offs.
Day 6	**Mock interview** Complete a full mock interview. Score yourself. Rewrite the three weakest answers.

Day 7	**Polish, don't cram** Practice concise delivery, prepare questions for the interviewer, check logistics and stop rewriting every sentence.

11 | FINAL CHECKLISTS & RESEARCH NOTES

The 60-second LinkedIn check

• I can tell what role this person wants next.
• The headline contains specific role/skill language.
• The About section gives evidence, not just adjectives.
• The experience section supports the same direction.
• The skills are truthful and relevant.
• The profile contains no obvious contradictions or unsupported claims.

The 60-second interview check

• My introduction is clear and under roughly 90 seconds.
• I have 6–8 adaptable stories.
• I can explain my strongest achievement with evidence.
• I have a credible weakness answer.
• I can explain why this role and why this company.
• I have researched the role and can ask thoughtful questions.
• I practice aloud rather than relying on silent reading.

The core principle

Clarity + evidence + relevance + authenticity. The goal is not to manufacture a perfect candidate. The goal is to make your real qualifications easier to understand.

Research Notes & Sources

The workbook's frameworks are original synthesis and practical templates informed by the following current guidance. Product interfaces and platform features can change; verify current LinkedIn settings when editing your profile.

LinkedIn Help — Edit Your Headline

Headline is displayed below the name, appears in search results, and can promote an area of expertise.

https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a542926/editing-your-professional-headline?lang=en

LinkedIn Help — Edit the About Section

About is a place to express mission, motivation and skills.

https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a553140/edit-the-about-section-in-your-profile?lang=en

LinkedIn Help — Job Recommendations

LinkedIn says job recommendations can use profile information including headline, About, experience and education.

https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a512279

LinkedIn Help — Skills Match

LinkedIn describes explicit and implicit skills and recommends keeping profile information current and descriptive.

https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a793433/skills-match-insight-on-jobs?lang=en

LinkedIn Talent Solutions — Profile Summary

Guidance emphasises audience/goal, what you do, why you do it, value and differentiation.

https://www.linkedin.com/business/talent/blog/product-tips/steps-to-perfect-profile-summary-for-recruiters

Indeed — STAR Interview Response Technique

Current guidance on Situation, Task, Action and Result, with emphasis on concrete actions and results.

https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/interviewing/how-to-use-the-star-interview-response-technique

Harvard FAS Mignone Center — AI for Interviews and Offers

Guidance on using generative AI for research, questions, answer brainstorming and STAR feedback, with fact-checking cautions.

https://careerservices.fas.harvard.edu/ai-interviews-and-offers/

UC Berkeley Career Engagement — Interview Process Overview

Guidance on research, self-assessment, behavioral stories, practice and post-interview debrief.

https://www.career.berkeley.edu/prepare-for-success/interviewing/

Harvard FAS Mignone Center — Mock Interview Questions

Examples covering motivation, questions for the interviewer and STAR-based challenging-situation answers.

https://careerservices.fas.harvard.edu/blog/2024/10/01/6-mock-interview-questions-and-how-to-answer-them/

Use with judgment

No framework guarantees an interview or offer. Use these templates to improve clarity and preparation, then adapt them to your actual experience, target role, industry and employer.